



YOU ARE **27 WEEKS AND 2 DAYS**

89 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

Your baby may be looking happy today. Babies smile and grimace, wrinkle their foreheads, and stick their tongues out. Many of these behaviors are only becoming more apparent now as 3-D ultrasound has provided a unique opportunity for their study.

“Your baby has developed a sleep–wake cycle very similar to the one they will have in the days and weeks after birth.”

Your baby's yawns have, until this point, occurred only occasionally as a single event but are now becoming more repetitive, with several yawns following one another. Your baby's swallowing reflexes were developed at 25 weeks but still need to become much better coordinated.

The baby's breathing movements are vital for the normal development of the lung tissue. Your baby does not breathe amniotic fluid into their lungs; The lungs are filled with fluid produced by the lung tissue itself, and as breathing movements are practiced, small amounts are expelled. With each breath, the diaphragm pushes down, and the chest wall moves in as the larynx relaxes, allowing fluid to escape. Only a tiny proportion (0.5 percent) of the fluid in the lung escapes with each breath. This compares to a fifth (20 percent) of the air in the lungs moving in and out with each breathing movement.

Your baby has been breathing for some weeks, but the pattern up until now has been somewhat random. Now, their breathing patterns start to reflect their better developed sleep–wake cycle and becomes more rhythmical.

PRENATAL CARE

You'll have prenatal appointments this week and at 32 and 36 weeks.

At each one, your blood pressure will be measured, and your urine tested for protein. The doctor will also check the size of your baby by measuring the height of your uterus and will listen to any concerns and offer you advice.

EATING A LITTLE MORE

You may feel hungrier now than you did earlier in pregnancy. This is to be expected as your developing baby is increasing rapidly in weight.

At this late stage of pregnancy, you need to increase your energy intake by about 200 calories per day; try to do so with healthy snacks and light meals. Here are a few suggestions:

- 2 tbsp of Greek yogurt with 1 banana.